

SUPPORT DEFLECTION MVP

Northstar Sprint

Strategy Deck for Northstar Retail Co.

Live prototype: northstar-support-buddy.lovable.app

Repository: github.com/Livingpr/The-Northstar-Sprint-Assignment

Repetitive questions are clogging a queue built for judgment calls

1

Where is my order?

Customers open a ticket to learn what a status lookup could tell them instantly.

2

When do I get refunded?

Return and refund status is sitting in a system the customer can't see.

3

Is it back in stock?

Availability questions repeat constantly and change by the hour.

Each one requires an agent to look up a record the customer could look up themselves — given the right interface.

SCOPE

Three ticket types, fully covered

Charter required deflecting at least two of three. All three shipped.



Order Status

Order ID lookup → item, quantity, order date, status, and a plain-language next step.



Returns & Refunds

Order ID lookup → return status, refund amount, return reason, next step by stage.

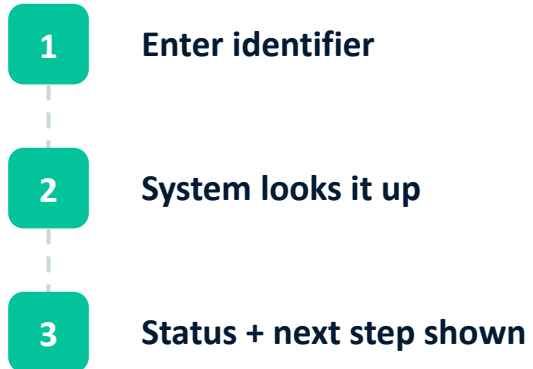


Stock Availability

Product name or ID search → live quantity, low-stock warning, or restock date.

One shape, repeated everywhere

Ask for one identifier → look it up → show status plus a concrete next action. A customer who learns one page already knows the rest.



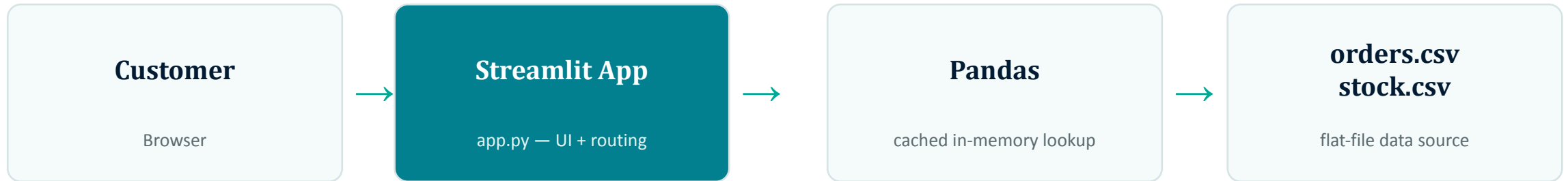
+ FAQ SAFETY NET

8 pre-written answers

Catches the long tail that doesn't fit the three structured lookups — tracking, non-delivery, return timelines, order changes.

- How can I track my order?
- How long until my refund?
- When will a product restock?
- Can I change my order?

Built for a one-week sprint, not a rewrite



WHY THESE CHOICES

Streamlit — A working, styled, multi-page UI in one Python file — no separate frontend build, fastest path to a live demo.

CSV + Pandas — No database needed for MVP scope; `@st.cache_data` means every lookup is an in-memory filter, not a live query.

Hosted + local — Hosted URL for stakeholder demo access; README documents a local streamlit run path for development.

RESULTS SNAPSHOT

Charter bar met — and exceeded

3 / 3

ticket types deflected

charter required ≥ 2 of 3

5

self-serve pages shipped

Home, Orders, Returns, Stock, FAQ

0

human handoffs required

for order, return, and stock lookups

KNOWN LIMITATIONS

- Static CSV data, not a live order/inventory system
- No customer authentication on lookups
- No deflection-rate analytics yet

NEXT STEPS

From MVP to production

1

Live data integration

Replace static CSVs with a real connection to Northstar's order-management and inventory systems.

2

Identity check

Pair order/return lookups with an email or account match before returning customer data.

3

Deflection analytics

Log lookup volume and “not found” rate to measure actual ticket deflection impact.

4

Content expansion

Grow the FAQ set from real post-launch question logs, not the initial assumed set.